

Skill Enhancement Policy for Higher Education — Amendment 1

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This amendment updates selected provisions of the Skill Enhancement Policy for Higher Education (TE/POL/2026/078). It incorporates feedback from the first implementation year, clarifies accreditation expectations, strengthens student equity provisions and aligns institutional reporting with the national skill database.

1. Purpose of This Amendment

Amendment 1 is issued following a structured consultation with institutions, industry partners and student representatives. Its purpose is to make the policy more practical to implement, more equitable in access and more consistent in certification and reporting. It does not alter the core objectives of the policy.

2. Amendments to Section 6 (Skill Development Framework)

Clause 6.1 — Foundational and Digital Skills

Sub-clause (b) is amended to read: "Foundational modules must accommodate students with limited prior digital exposure. Institutions must provide bridge sessions before core training and permit completion across two semesters where needed."

Clause 6.3 — Vocational and Certification Programmes

A new sub-clause is inserted after clause 6.3(b): "Institutions must ensure that at least one accessible vocational pathway is available to students with disabilities, including alternative assessment arrangements where necessary."

3. Amendment to Section 7.3 (Assessment and Certification)

The sentence "Certification is issued by the institution in collaboration with the industry or sector partner" is amended to read: "Certification is issued by the institution in collaboration with the industry or sector partner, provided the assessment is conducted against a rubric published before the module begins. Where a national skill qualification exists, certification must align with that qualification's standards."

4. Amendment to Section 8 (Roles and Responsibilities)

The row for "Students" is amended to add: "and must receive, on completion of a module, a certificate that states the competency achieved and the assessment rubric applied".

5. Insertion of Section 8A — Equity in Skill Access

A new section 8A is inserted after Section 8. It requires institutions to: (i) waive or subsidise skill certification fees for students from economically weaker backgrounds; (ii) design timetables so that modular offerings do not exclude students in work placements; and (iii) provide advising that helps students choose pathways suited to their abilities and aspirations.

6. Amendment to Section 9 (Monitoring and Evaluation)

Monitoring indicators are expanded to include: certification attainment by student category; share of students completing a foundational module; and the number of accessible pathway variants offered. Institutions must submit these additional indicators with their next annual report.

7. Transitional Arrangements

Institutions already implementing programmes under the original policy may continue them during the current academic year, and must be aligned with this amendment from the start of the next academic year. Existing certifications issued under the original provisions remain valid.

8. Effective Date

This amendment takes effect from the beginning of the next academic year, notified in writing by the Technical Education Department. Institutions seeking clarification may direct queries through the official portal.

9. Acknowledgment

The Technical Education Department thanks institutions, industry partners, faculty and students whose feedback shaped this amendment, and looks forward to continued collaboration in strengthening skill development across higher education.